The AI Diagnostic

Score your organisation across 6 dimensions in 30 minutes.
Know exactly where you stand before spending another pound on AI.

> *Most mid-market companies are spending money on AI without knowing where they stand. 67% lack a unified AI strategy. 56% of CEOs say their AI spend hasn't delivered measurable results.*

Before you buy another tool, run another pilot, or hire another vendor, you need to know where you actually are.

This is the diagnostic I run at the start of every fractional CAIO engagement. It takes 30 to 60 minutes with your leadership team and gives you a clear, honest picture of your AI position.

You don't need me to run it. You don't need any special tools. You need a room, your CEO, CTO, and CFO, and the willingness to be honest about the answers.

What you'll get

- → A scored assessment across 6 dimensions
- → A clear view of where you're strong and where the gaps are
- → Enough clarity to decide what to do next, whether that's engaging help or moving forward internally

AI Diagnostic: Score Your Organisation

Score each dimension 1 to 5 with your leadership team. Be honest: the value is in the accuracy, not the score.

1 = Not started **2** = Aware, no action **3** = Some activity, uncoordinated **4** = Structured, partially implemented **5** = Mature, embedded, measured

1. AI Strategy

Score: ___ / 5

- Do we have a documented AI strategy tied to business outcomes?
- Can our CEO, CTO, and CFO each explain the same AI priorities?
- Do we know which 2 or 3 business problems AI should solve first?
- Is there a prioritised roadmap with timelines and owners?

Good: A one-page strategy document that every board member can explain, tied to specific revenue or cost outcomes.

2. AI Governance

Score: ___ / 5

- Do we have a written AI usage policy?
- Do we know which AI tools employees are actually using? (Shadow AI)
- Is there a data classification framework for what can and can't go into AI tools?
- Do we have an approved tool list with criteria for adding new ones?

Good: A governance framework that employees actually know about, with clear rules on data handling and tool approval.

3. AI Leadership & Ownership

Score: ___ / 5

- Is there a single named person responsible for AI strategy?
- Does AI have a regular slot on the board agenda?
- Are AI decisions made proactively or reactively?
- Can leadership articulate the difference between AI strategy and AI tools?

Good: One person owns the AI portfolio, reports to the board monthly, and connects every initiative to a business outcome.

4. AI Skills & Capability

Score: ___ / 5

- Has the leadership team received AI training (not just staff)?
- Do managers know how to evaluate AI outputs in their domain?
- Can the team distinguish between AI hype and practical application?
- Is there a plan for building internal AI capability over time?

Good: Leaders can make informed AI decisions without external help. Staff know how to use approved tools effectively and safely.

5. Data Readiness

Score: ___ / 5

- Is our core business data accurate, complete, and accessible?
- Can our key systems (CRM, ERP, finance) share data?
- Do we have named data owners for critical datasets?
- Do we know what data we'd need for our priority AI use cases?

Good: Key data is clean, connected across systems, and someone is accountable for its quality.

6. AI Execution

Score: ___ / 5

- Have we completed any AI pilots with measurable outcomes?
- Do our pilots have defined success criteria before they start?
- Have any pilots graduated to production-scale deployment?
- Do we measure AI ROI with the same rigour as other investments?

Good: 1 to 2 pilots have shipped to production with documented results. Failed pilots were killed early, not left running.

Your Score

DIMENSION	SCORE
1. AI Strategy	/ 5
2. AI Governance	/ 5
3. AI Leadership & Ownership	/ 5
4. AI Skills & Capability	/ 5
5. Data Readiness	/ 5
6. AI Execution	/ 5
TOTAL	**/ 30**

What Your Score Means

24 to 30: Leading. You're ahead of most mid-market companies. Focus on scaling what works and preparing for agentic AI.

18 to 23: Progressing. You have foundations in place but gaps to close. Prioritise the lowest-scoring dimensions, as they're holding back the rest.

12 to 17: Early stage. You're aware AI matters but lack the structure to execute. Start with strategy and governance before buying more tools.

6 to 11: At risk. AI decisions are being made without strategy, governance, or ownership. The longer this continues, the more expensive the correction.

What To Do Next

Scored 18+? You may not need external help. Use this diagnostic quarterly to track progress. Focus on your weakest dimension.

Scored 12 to 17? Consider a focused engagement. A 2-day AI diagnostic with an independent advisor can turn this score into a prioritised action plan.

Scored under 12? You need AI leadership. Whether that's a fractional CAIO, an internal hire, or a structured consultancy engagement, doing nothing is the most expensive option.

About the Author

Jamie Oarton is a fractional Chief AI Officer through Bramforth AI, helping UK mid-market companies (£20M to £100M revenue) build AI strategies that actually connect to how they make money.

He has advised on AI strategy at the highest levels of UK government, military, and diplomatic services, and has delivered AI training to senior British Army officers.

Jamie works with companies that know AI matters but don't have a plan, building strategy, setting governance, and making sure AI investments deliver measurable results rather than expensive experiments.

AI Diagnostic

A 2-day audit of where you are, what's working, and what to do next.

~£2,500

Fractional CAIO

1 to 2 days per week embedded in your leadership team, building strategy, governance, and capability.

From £4,000/month

Want to Talk?

If this resource was useful and you'd like to explore whether a fractional CAIO makes sense for your business, the first conversation is always free and no-pressure.

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